

Employing in Greece

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant contracts under the Greek Labour Code
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in EUR, itemised payslips, 14 payments per year
- **Tax withholding** — progressive income tax withheld and remitted monthly
- **e-EFKA** — the unified social security fund covering pension, health and unemployment
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods, entitlements and severance guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

Greek employees are paid over 14 salary instalments per year — 12 monthly payments plus a Christmas bonus (full month) and Easter/summer bonuses (half-month each).

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
14-payment salary structure	12 months + Christmas bonus (full month) + Easter and summer bonuses (half-month each)	Labour Code
Probation period	Typically 12 months (statutory default for notice purposes)	Labour Code
Standard hours	8 hrs/day, 40 hrs/week	Labour Code

Minimum Wage & e-EFKA Contributions (2026)

Measure	Rate	Notes
Minimum wage	€1,027/month (14-payment basis)	Set by government decree, reviewed periodically
Employer e-EFKA contribution (white-collar)	~22.3% of gross salary	Covers main pension, supplementary pension (TEKA for new entrants), health and unemployment funds
Employee e-EFKA contribution	~15.3%-16.8% of gross salary	Higher for blue-collar/heavy-work categories

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	20 days/year (5-day week), rising to 25 with tenure	Employer	Labour Code minimum
Christmas/Easter/Summer Bonuses	1 full month (Christmas) + 2 half-months (Easter, summer)	Employer	Mandatory 14th-payment structure
Maternity Leave	17 weeks (8 before + 9 after birth)	e-EFKA (100% of salary, capped)	Job-protected extension available thereafter

★ HERO TIP

Greece's 14-payment salary structure means the true annual cost of any Greek salary is roughly 16.7% higher than the monthly figure alone suggests — always budget on an annual basis (monthly × 14, plus e-EFKA) rather than multiplying by 12. New labour market entrants are enrolled in the newer TEKA supplementary pension scheme rather than the legacy e-EFKA supplementary fund — confirm which applies for each new hire.

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Total Cost Example — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
Employer e-EFKA (illustrative, 22.3%)	\$669.00	22.30%
EOR service fee (HeroForce, Tier 2)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$4,269.00	~142.3%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month (Tier 2 pricing), no setup fee. This excludes the pro-rated cost of the Christmas/Easter/summer bonuses, which add a further ~16.7% in annualised cost. Employee deductions (withheld separately) include e-EFKA contributions (~15.3%+) and progressive income tax, with a tax credit of up to €777 for lower incomes.

Income Tax

Greece applies a 5-bracket progressive income tax scale (introduced following the 2011 debt-crisis reforms), with a tax credit reducing the effective rate for lower earners.

Termination & Separation

Notice and severance in Greece scale together with length of service under the Labour Code — statutory severance for indefinite-term employees ranges from 1 month's pay (under 2 years' service) up to 12 months' pay (17+ years' service), with notice periods calculated on a similar sliding scale.

★ HERO TIP

Greek severance calculations combine length of service, whether proper written notice was given (which can halve the amount due), and salary averaging rules — a small procedural miss can materially change the amount owed. Always route Greek terminations through your HeroForce EOR to confirm the correct calculation before issuing notice.

Public Holidays 2026

Date	Holiday	Type
1 January	New Year's Day	National
6 January	Epiphany	National
~February/March	Clean Monday (Orthodox Lent begins)	National (Orthodox calendar)
25 March	Greek Independence Day	National
~April	Orthodox Good Friday and Easter Monday	National (Orthodox calendar)
1 May	Labour Day	National
~June	Orthodox Whit Monday	National (Orthodox calendar)
15 August	Assumption Day	National
28 October	Ohi Day	National
25–26 December	Christmas Day and 2nd Day of Christmas	National

Greece follows the Eastern Orthodox calendar for Easter and related holidays, which frequently differs from the Western (Catholic/Protestant) date.

Ready to hire in Greece?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries. Onboard your first Greece employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month, no setup fee (Tier 2).